Project Management Plan

Incident Response Plan Development

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Sponsoring Organization	National Cyber Emergency Response Team (NCERT)

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Purpose of This Document

This Project Management Plan (PMP) expands on the approved Project Charter for the Incident Response Plan Development project. It defines how the project will be planned, executed, monitored, controlled, and closed — covering scope, schedule, cost, quality, resourcing, communication, risk, procurement, stakeholders, and change control.

1.2 Project Summary

The project will design, develop, and implement a formal Incident Response Plan (IRP) that enables the organization to detect, contain, eradicate, and recover from cybersecurity incidents through a structured, tested process. The project runs over 4 months (September–December 2026) with an estimated budget of $40,700. The project is managed by Muneeb Mehmood and sponsored by the National Cyber Emergency Response Team (NCERT).

1.3 Project Objectives

- Develop a documented, management-approved Incident Response Plan within 4 months
- Define incident severity classification and escalation procedures
- Establish a dedicated Incident Response Team (IRT) with clearly assigned roles
- Create playbooks for ransomware, phishing, data breach, and DDoS incidents
- Validate the plan through a tabletop exercise
- Reduce average expected incident containment and response time

2.0 Scope Management Plan

2.1 Scope Statement

In scope: an Incident Response policy and plan document, formation of the Incident Response Team, playbooks for the four most likely incident types, communication and escalation procedures, integration with existing monitoring tools, and a tabletop exercise to validate the plan.

Out of scope: purchasing new security tools or technology, building a Security Operations Center from scratch, and compliance obligations beyond incident reporting. Physical security incidents are excluded — the plan covers IT and network security incidents only.

2.2 Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

The project is broken into 10 phases and 20 work packages, detailed in the Schedule Management Plan below.

2.3 Scope Verification

Each deliverable is reviewed against its acceptance criteria (see Quality Management Plan, Section 5) and formally accepted by the Project Manager and relevant functional lead before the next phase begins.

2.4 Scope Change Control

Any request to add or remove work from the defined scope follows the Change Management process in Section 11 — no scope change is actioned without a logged change request and sponsor approval.

3.0 Schedule Management Plan

3.1 Scheduling Approach

The schedule follows a phased approach across 4 months (1 Sep – 22 Dec 2026), with each phase gated by a review checkpoint. Tasks are sequenced so that policy and team-formation work completes before playbook development, and all playbooks are finished before the tabletop exercise validates them.

3.2 Detailed Task List

ID	Task	Owner	Duration	Start	End	Dependency
1.1	Kickoff meeting & charter review	Project Manager	1 day	1 Sep	1 Sep	—
1.2	Current-state security posture assessment	IT Security	8 days	2 Sep	12 Sep	1.1
2.1	Define incident severity classification	IT Security / Legal	8 days	15 Sep	24 Sep	1.2
2.2	Draft escalation & notification procedures	IT Security / Legal	6 days	22 Sep	2 Oct	2.1
3.1	Identify & recruit IRT members	NCERT (Sponsor) / HR	6 days	22 Sep	29 Sep	1.2
3.2	Define IRT roles & RACI	Project Manager	4 days	29 Sep	2 Oct	3.1
4.1	Ransomware response playbook	IT Security	8 days	5 Oct	14 Oct	2.2, 3.2
4.2	Phishing response playbook	IT Security	6 days	12 Oct	19 Oct	2.2, 3.2
4.3	Data breach response playbook	IT Security / Legal	8 days	19 Oct	28 Oct	2.2, 3.2
4.4	DDoS response playbook	Network Operations	6 days	28 Oct	6 Nov	2.2, 3.2
5.1	Internal notification templates	Communications	6 days	26 Oct	2 Nov	2.2
5.2	External / regulator notification templates	Communications / Legal	8 days	3 Nov	13 Nov	5.1
6.1	Map plan to SOC / monitoring alerts	IT Security	6 days	9 Nov	16 Nov	4.1–4.4
6.2	Configure escalation triggers	IT Security	4 days	16 Nov	20 Nov	6.1
7.1	Design tabletop exercise scenario	External Consultant	3 days	23 Nov	25 Nov	6.2
7.2	Conduct tabletop exercise	Full IRT	2 days	26 Nov	27 Nov	7.1
8.1	Incorporate lessons learned	Project Manager / IT Security	6 days	30 Nov	7 Dec	7.2
8.2	Final plan review & QA	Project Manager	4 days	7 Dec	11 Dec	8.1
9.1	Management / board presentation	PM / NCERT (Sponsor)	2 days	14 Dec	15 Dec	8.2
9.2	Formal sign-off	NCERT (Sponsor)	3 days	15 Dec	18 Dec	9.1
10.1	Archive documentation & handover to operations	Project Manager	1 day	21 Dec	21 Dec	9.2
10.2	Project closeout report & lessons learned log	Project Manager	1 day	22 Dec	22 Dec	10.1

3.3 Detailed Activity Descriptions

Every task in the schedule is explained below — what it involves, who does it, and what it produces — so there is no ambiguity about what each line of the schedule actually means.

Phase 1 — Kickoff & Assessment

- 1.1 Kickoff meeting & charter review: The Project Manager (Muneeb Mehmood) holds a kickoff meeting with representatives from IT Security, Legal, HR, and Communications to walk through the approved Project Charter, confirm objectives, and secure each department's resource commitment before any work begins. Output: a shared understanding of scope, timeline, and responsibilities.
- 1.2 Current-state security posture assessment: IT Security reviews the organization's existing monitoring tools, logging capability, and any informal incident-handling habits already in place. This step identifies real

gaps to close and avoids duplicating controls that already exist. Output: a current-state assessment summary that feeds directly into the policy and playbook work.

Phase 2 — Policy & Governance

- 2.1 Define incident severity classification: IT Security and Legal jointly agree on a severity scale (for example Low / Medium / High / Critical) based on business impact, data sensitivity, and how many systems are affected. This ensures every future incident is triaged the same way instead of being judged case by case. Output: a severity matrix used throughout the rest of the plan.
- 2.2 Draft escalation & notification procedures: Building on the severity matrix, IT Security and Legal define exactly who must be told at each severity level, how fast, and through what channel — including any legal notification deadlines. Output: an escalation flowchart embedded in the final IR policy document.

Phase 3 — Team Formation

- 3.1 Identify & recruit IRT members: NCERT (as Sponsor) and HR identify representatives from IT Security, Network Operations, Legal, HR, and Communications to sit on the Incident Response Team, and confirm each person's availability for both planning work and real incidents. Output: a confirmed IRT roster.
- 3.2 Define IRT roles & RACI: The Project Manager documents exactly who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, and Informed at each stage of incident response, removing any confusion about who acts first during a real event. Output: the RACI matrix shown in Section 6.2.

Phase 4 — Playbook Development

- 4.1 Ransomware response playbook: IT Security documents the exact steps for a ransomware event — isolating affected systems, preserving evidence, checking backup integrity, and coordinating recovery, without defaulting to paying a ransom. Output: a standalone ransomware playbook.
- 4.2 Phishing response playbook: IT Security documents how to respond when a phishing attempt is reported or detected, including containing compromised accounts, forcing password resets, and warning potentially affected employees. Output: a standalone phishing playbook.
- 4.3 Data breach response playbook: IT Security and Legal jointly document the steps for a suspected data breach — forensic investigation, determining exactly what data was exposed, and meeting legal notification duties to affected individuals and regulators. Output: a standalone data breach playbook.
- 4.4 DDoS response playbook: Network Operations documents how to detect and mitigate a Distributed Denial of Service attack, including engaging the internet service provider and switching on traffic-filtering rules. Output: a standalone DDoS playbook.

Phase 5 — Communications

- 5.1 Internal notification templates: Communications drafts pre-approved internal messages for employees and leadership, so nobody has to write from scratch while an incident is underway. Output: a set of internal message templates.
- 5.2 External / regulator notification templates: Communications and Legal jointly draft external-facing templates for customers, regulators, and media, with the legal wording and required disclosures already approved in advance. Output: a set of external message templates.

Phase 6 — Tooling Integration

- 6.1 Map plan to SOC / monitoring alerts: IT Security reviews which existing monitoring alerts should trigger which playbook, so detection tools feed directly into the response process instead of requiring manual interpretation. Output: an alert-to-playbook mapping document.
- 6.2 Configure escalation triggers: IT Security configures the monitoring tools so alerts above a defined severity automatically notify the right IRT members, following the escalation procedure from Activity 2.2. Output: configured, tested alerting rules.

Phase 7 — Validation

- 7.1 Design tabletop exercise scenario: The external consultant designs a realistic incident scenario — for example, a simulated ransomware event — to test the plan without touching any real system. Output: a written tabletop exercise script.

- 7.2 Conduct tabletop exercise: The full Incident Response Team walks through the simulated scenario in real time, following the draft plan and playbooks, while the consultant observes and records gaps. Output: a facilitation record and a list of findings.

Phase 8 — Finalization

- 8.1 Incorporate lessons learned: The Project Manager and IT Security review the tabletop findings and update the policy, playbooks, and escalation procedures to close every gap identified. Output: a revised draft plan.
- 8.2 Final plan review & QA: The Project Manager checks the finished plan against the acceptance criteria in Section 5, confirming every deliverable is complete and consistent before it goes forward for approval. Output: a QA-approved final plan.

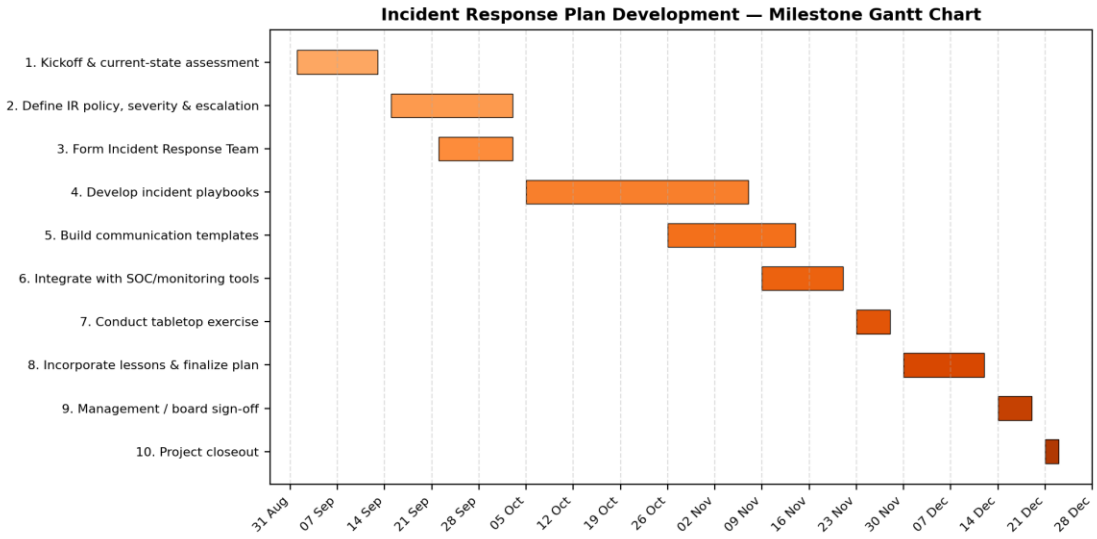
Phase 9 — Approval

- 9.1 Management / board presentation: The Project Manager and NCERT (Sponsor) present the finalized plan, its test results, and recommendations to senior management for approval. Output: a presentation deck and a record of the approval discussion.
- 9.2 Formal sign-off: NCERT, as Sponsor, formally signs off on the plan, authorizing it as the organization's official Incident Response Plan. Output: a signed approval record.

Phase 10 — Closeout

- 10.1 Archive documentation & handover to operations: The Project Manager hands over all final documents to the IT Security / SOC team, who take ownership of maintaining the plan going forward. Output: an archived, version-controlled set of documents.
- 10.2 Project closeout report & lessons learned log: The Project Manager compiles a closeout report summarizing what was delivered, how the budget performed, and lessons learned for future projects. Output: a final closeout report.

3.4 Milestone Gantt Chart



3.5 Schedule Control

Progress is tracked weekly against the task list above. Any task slipping more than 3 working days triggers a review by the Project Manager and, if it affects a downstream dependency, a revised schedule is issued and communicated to affected stakeholders.

4.0 Cost Management Plan

4.1 Budget Summary

External IR consultant (tabletop design & facilitation)	$10,000
Plan documentation & playbook development	$6,000
Tabletop exercise logistics	$3,000
Internal staff time (~0.4 FTE × 4 months)	$18,000
Contingency reserve (10%)	$3,700
Total estimated budget	$40,700

4.2 Cost Control

Actual spend is tracked monthly against the budget line items above. Any variance greater than 10% on a single line item is flagged to the Sponsor, and use of the contingency reserve requires Project Manager sign-off.

4.3 Contingency Reserve

A 10% contingency ($3,700) is held against unplanned costs — for example, extended consultant time if the tabletop exercise surfaces gaps requiring a second facilitated session.

5.0 Quality Management Plan

5.1 Acceptance Criteria for Key Deliverables

- IR Policy & Plan: reviewed and approved by Legal and NCERT (Sponsor); written in plain, actionable language
- Playbooks: each playbook independently walked through by a reviewer not involved in drafting it, with no unresolved gaps
- Communication templates: approved by Legal and Communications, covering all required regulatory notification timelines
- Tabletop exercise: completed with full IRT attendance and a documented findings report
- Final plan: zero open critical findings at the point of sign-off

5.2 Quality Assurance Activities

Each deliverable passes through a peer review (by a team member outside the drafting function), a Legal/compliance review where applicable, and a final Project Manager review before being marked complete.

5.3 Quality Control

The tabletop exercise itself functions as the primary quality control gate — it validates whether the plan works in practice, not just on paper. Any gap identified is logged and must be closed before final sign-off (Section 8.2 of the schedule).

6.0 Resource & Team Management Plan

6.1 Project Organization

The National Cyber Emergency Response Team (NCERT) sponsors the project and holds final approval authority. The Project Manager, Muneeb Mehmood, runs day-to-day execution and reports to NCERT. IT Security, Network Operations, Legal, HR, and Corporate Communications each contribute subject-matter work within their function, and an external consultant is engaged specifically to design and facilitate the tabletop exercise.

6.2 RACI Matrix

Activity	PM	NCERT	IT Sec	Legal	HR/Comms	Consult.
Charter approval	**R**	**A**	**C**	**C**	**I**	**I**
Current-state assessment	**A**	**I**	**R**	**I**	**I**	**C**
Policy & severity definition	**A**	**I**	**R**	**C**	**I**	**I**
IRT formation	**R**	**A**	**C**	**I**	**C**	**I**
Playbook development	**A**	**I**	**R**	**C**	**I**	**C**
Communication templates	**A**	**I**	**C**	**C**	**R**	**I**
Tooling integration	**A**	**I**	**R**	**I**	**I**	**I**
Tabletop exercise	**A**	**I**	**R**	**C**	**C**	**R**
Plan finalization & sign-off	**R**	**A**	**C**	**C**	**I**	**I**
Project closeout	**R**	**A**	**I**	**I**	**I**	**I**

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

6.3 Team Training Needs

- IRT members: role-specific briefing on their responsibilities before the tabletop exercise
- All staff: brief awareness session at plan launch, covering how and when to report a suspected incident
- IT Security: technical walkthrough of updated monitoring/escalation configuration

7.0 Communications Management Plan

Audience	Information	Frequency	Method	Owner
NCERT (Sponsor)	Overall status, risks, budget	Bi-weekly	Status report + meeting	Project Manager
Incident Response Team	Task assignments, draft reviews	Weekly	Team meeting / email	Project Manager
IT Security & Network Ops	Technical requirements, playbook review	Weekly	Working sessions	IT Security Lead
Legal & Compliance	Regulatory requirements, template review	Bi-weekly	Review meetings	Legal Lead
HR & Communications	Training rollout, internal messaging	Monthly	Email / meeting	HR Lead
All staff	Awareness of new IR procedures	Once at launch + annual refresh	All-hands email / training	Communications
External Consultant	Tabletop design, deliverable review	As needed per phase	Email / calls	Project Manager
Board / Senior Management	Final plan approval	End of project	Formal presentation	NCERT (Sponsor)

8.0 Risk Management Plan

8.1 Approach

Risks are identified at kickoff and reviewed at each phase gate. Each risk is scored on likelihood and impact (Low / Medium / High) and assigned an owner responsible for its response strategy.

8.2 Risk Register

ID	Category	Description	Likelihood	Impact	Score	Response Strategy	Owner
R1	Technical	Existing tooling gaps limit detection or containment	Medium	High	High	Mitigate — early tooling gap assessment	IT Security
R2	Organizational	Key IRT members unavailable during a real incident	Medium	High	High	Mitigate — define backup/deputy roles	NCERT (Sponsor)
R3	Schedule	Tabletop exercise delayed by stakeholder availability	Medium	Medium	Medium	Mitigate — book calendar slots early	Project Manager
R4	Compliance	Regulatory reporting deadlines missed due to unclear escalation	Low	High	Medium	Mitigate — Legal review of escalation paths	Legal
R5	Organizational	Cross-department coordination breakdown during an incident	Medium	Medium	Medium	Mitigate — joint IRT training sessions	Project Manager
R6	Financial	External consultant costs exceed budget	Low	Medium	Low	Accept / monitor — fixed-price contract	Project Manager
R7	Quality	Plan not realistically tested before a real incident	Medium	High	High	Mitigate — tabletop exercise + annual re-test	NCERT (Sponsor)
R8	Technical	Playbooks become outdated as threats evolve	Medium	Medium	Medium	Mitigate — scheduled quarterly review	IT Security
R9	Organizational	Staff resistance to new reporting procedures	Low	Low	Low	Mitigate — change communication & training	HR / Comms

8.3 Risk Monitoring

The risk register is reviewed at every bi-weekly sponsor update. New risks are added as they emerge; closed risks are logged with their resolution for the project's lessons-learned record.

9.0 Procurement Management Plan

9.1 Make-vs-Buy

Most work is performed internally using existing IT Security, Legal, HR, and Communications staff. The exception is tabletop exercise design and facilitation, which is procured externally because it requires specialized incident-simulation experience not available in-house.

9.2 Vendor Selection Criteria

- Demonstrated incident response / tabletop facilitation experience
- Verifiable references from comparable organizations
- Cost within the allocated $10,000 budget line
- Availability within the November tabletop window

9.3 Contract Management

The consultant is engaged under a fixed-price contract tied to two deliverables: exercise scenario design and facilitated delivery. The Project Manager approves each deliverable before payment is released.

10.0 Stakeholder Management Plan

Stakeholder	Interest	Influence	Engagement Strategy
NCERT (Sponsor)	High	High	Keep closely engaged with regular updates; final decision-maker on plan approval
IT Security Team	High	Medium	Actively involve in playbook drafting and tooling integration
Legal & Compliance	Medium	High	Consult on regulatory requirements; review all notification templates
HR Department	Medium	Medium	Involve in team formation and staff training rollout
Corporate Communications	Medium	Medium	Involve in drafting internal and external messaging
Network Operations	Medium	Medium	Involve in DDoS playbook and tooling integration work
All Employees	Low	Low	Inform via a brief awareness session and training at launch
External IR Consultant	Medium	Medium	Engage per contract scope for tabletop design and facilitation
Board / Senior Management	High	High	Present the final plan for approval; periodic high-level updates
Cyber Insurance Provider	Low	Medium	Share the final plan if required as a condition of coverage

11.0 Change Management Plan

11.1 Change Control Process

- 1. Anyone on the project team can submit a change request describing the proposed change and reason
- 2. The Project Manager logs the request and assesses its impact on scope, cost, and schedule
- 3. Changes affecting the timeline by more than 5 working days or the budget by more than 10% require approval from NCERT (Sponsor)
- 4. Approved changes are incorporated into the plan and schedule, which is then re-baselined
- 5. All affected stakeholders are notified of the change and the revised plan

11.2 Change Request Record Fields

- Requestor name and date
- Description of the requested change
- Reason / business justification
- Impact on scope, cost, and schedule
- Priority (Low / Medium / High)
- Approval status and approver

12.0 Monitoring, Control & Reporting

12.1 Key Performance Indicators

- Percentage of milestones completed on schedule
- Budget variance against the approved $40,700 baseline
- Playbook completion rate (of 4 planned playbooks)
- Number of tabletop exercise findings closed before sign-off
- IRT training completion rate (target: 100%)

12.2 Reporting Cadence

Internal team status updates occur weekly; a consolidated status report goes to NCERT (Sponsor) bi-weekly, covering schedule status, budget status, open risks, and any decisions needed.

12.3 Issue Escalation

- Level 1 — Project Manager resolves day-to-day issues within the team
- Level 2 — Issues affecting scope, cost, or schedule escalate to NCERT (Sponsor)
- Level 3 — Issues requiring cross-organizational decisions escalate to senior management / the board

13.0 Project Closure Plan

13.1 Closure Criteria

- All deliverables reviewed, approved, and signed off by NCERT (Sponsor)
- Tabletop exercise completed and all critical findings closed
- Final Incident Response Plan formally approved by management
- Plan ownership transitioned to the IT Security / SOC team for ongoing maintenance

13.2 Lessons Learned

A post-project review meeting is held with the full project team to capture what worked well, what didn't, and recommendations for future projects. Findings are logged in a lessons-learned record for future reference.

13.3 Handover & Ongoing Ownership

Ownership of the Incident Response Plan transfers to the IT Security team at closeout, with a recommended quarterly review cadence and an annual tabletop re-test to keep the plan current as the threat landscape evolves.